

CHARACTERS.md — Alex, Katya, Family & Personalization Rules

Scope: everything personal. This file is the single source of truth for names, birthdays, interests, motivation, and privacy rules. Teaching rules are in EDUCATION.md; game mechanics in GAME_DESIGN.md.

PRIVACY RULES (read before using anything below)

The app is currently **for this family only**, so real personal details stay in the app to make it feel genuinely personal. However:

- This information must remain **private**. It must never appear in public demos, screenshots, sample data, shared links, or public repositories.
- Real names, birthdays, school materials, and progress must never appear in public repos or logs (see DEVELOPMENT_RULES.md → Data & privacy rules).
- If the app is ever opened to other families (Priority 4), replace ALL real names and personal details with **editable profile fields and safe sample data**. Architect personal details as data (parent-editable fields), not hardcoded strings, to make this conversion possible.
- Family references must always feel warm, playful, and supportive — never sources of shame, punishment, or pressure.

Family reference (may appear in private personalized content)

- **Yulia** — mother (app creator, parent-admin)
- **Vadim** — father; treats Katya like a princess, loves coffee
- **Grandma Olga** — encourages everyone to speak Russian
- **Grandma Margarita**
- **Grandpa Serezha** — buys gifts for both children
- **Aryna** — Katya's friend, lives in Alberta
- **Tolik the Elf** — seasonal/playful story character

-  **Leila and Emily** — no longer friends. **Remove from the app** and never use again (removal tracked in FUTURE_IDEAS.md → Now).
-

ALEX

Basic profile

- Primary profile name: **Alex**; family nickname **Sasha** (usable in family-facing content; "Alex" stays primary unless Yulia asks to change it)
- Birthday: **December 29, 2013** (use for automatic age calculation)
- Entering **Grade 8** in September 2026
- Device: **iPad** (design tablet-first)
- Theme: ⚡ battle / champion / strategy; accent = the app's Alex colorway

Interests: gaming (PS5; Fortnite, Valorant; loves Horizon — played all Horizon games with his mother, completed maps repeatedly), chess, fencing (2x/week), Duolingo (500+ day streak — proof he sustains streaks), YouTube about conspiracy theories, investigations, mysterious places, UFOs and unexplained events, food and eating out (Subway, Popeyes), vacations/travel/ freedom, hugs and family affection. Helps with dishes and chores; earns \$20/week for chores.

Motivated by: daily streaks; clear, concrete requirements; IXL-style visible progress systems; games and gaming rewards; money; food/eating out (Popeyes, Subway); freedom and independence; vacations and exciting future plans; competition; unlocking rewards; hugs and positive attention; feeling capable and successful.

Demotivated/frustrated by: device removal; punishment-focused systems; arguments with parents; repetitive studying without a clear purpose; being pushed only for grades; long tasks needing sustained focus without variety; activities that feel like schoolwork with no challenge, reward, or reason.

Strengths: extremely persistent — rarely quits once committed; smart, grasps new concepts quickly; kind; responsible; completes what's necessary; excellent at routines and streaks; responds well to clear systems; works independently when expectations are concrete; strong strategic/problem-solving interests; long commitment when the goal matters to him.

Struggle areas: doesn't naturally enjoy studying; may avoid sustained focus; may rush and not do his best; doesn't care strongly about school marks; often needs his mother's push academically; may do the minimum to avoid conflict; needs a meaningful purpose,

challenge, or reward; benefits from shorter missions, visible progress, and optional competition; encourage quality without making marks the only goal.

Design guidance for Alex

- Use battle, champion, strategy, and investigation themes; missions, streaks, levels, maps, unlockable rewards; gaming-style progress without making every activity feel aggressive.
 - Use mystery / UFO / investigation / unexplained-world themes where age-appropriate.
 - Connect math and future subjects to money, food, games, travel, chess, and strategy.
 - Reward persistence and careful work, not only speed; add reminders to slow down, check answers, and improve quality.
 - Avoid: punishment-heavy language, device-loss threats, grades as the only measure of success.
-

KATYA

Basic profile

- Name: **Katya**
- Birthday: **May 4, 2016** (use for automatic age calculation)
- Entering **Grade 5** in September 2026
- Device: **Lenovo Android tablet** (design tablet-first)
- Theme: 🔍 mystery / detective; accent = the app's Katya colorway

Interests: mysteries (especially mystery stories told through **text messages**), YouTube mystery content, Roblox, Dress to Impress, Toca Boca (especially with her mother), Sephora, shopping, bubble tea, sushi (avocado rolls), chocolate (especially peanut-butter chocolate), road trips, dancing, hugs and family affection, Tolik the Elf. Cares about friendships, appearance, and social life. Very responsible: keeps her room clean and organized, packs her own belongings carefully. Wants to be good at school and be seen as smart.

Motivated by: shopping and Sephora-related rewards; takeout, sushi/avocado rolls, bubble tea, peanut-butter chocolate; playing Toca Boca with her mother; road trips; dancing; hugs and positive family attention; feeling **trusted**; being given responsibility; understanding **why** a task matters; feeling smart and capable; completing things well; organization, preparation,

and visible achievement; personal and social recognition.

Demotivated/frustrated by: not being trusted; being yelled at; feeling controlled without explanation; being blocked from what she wants without understanding why; feeling misunderstood; being treated as irresponsible; harsh criticism; tasks that don't explain their purpose; environments with too many social distractions.

Strengths: responsible, organized, smart; wants to succeed academically and be good at everything she does; plans and packs carefully; understands expectations well when the reason is explained; social and expressive; creative; highly committed when she feels ownership; cares about quality and presentation.

Struggle areas: easily distracted when studying (especially by peers at school); very social; can be stubborn; may yell when upset; sometimes struggles to control strong emotions; resists when she feels distrusted; needs explanations of why something is required; may need calm-down time before returning to a task; must not be shamed for emotional reactions; benefits from structure, choices, and advance preparation.

Design guidance for Katya

- Use mystery, detective, fashion, shopping, and creative themes; personalized stories and **text-message-style mystery challenges**.
- Give responsibility-based roles: planner, detective, organizer, team leader.
- Offer controlled choices; explain why each task matters.
- Use visual organization, checklists, and packing-style preparation.
- Include dance, travel, fashion, Roblox, Toca Boca, and shopping themes where suitable.
- Reward responsibility, emotional recovery, and focused effort.
- Avoid: yelling/punishment language, trust-removing language, public comparison with peers, and any use of **Leila or Emily**. Aryna may appear (she lives in Alberta).

General personalization rules (both children)

- Personalize by interests, motivation, strengths, and current needs — do not reduce either child to a fixed personality type.
- Interests and preferences must be **editable over time** (eventually parent-controlled profile fields).
- Separate identity from performance; praise effort, persistence, careful thinking,

responsibility, and improvement (full feedback rules: EDUCATION.md → Feedback & motivation).

- Never use humiliation, fear, or device removal as motivation.
- Never compare Alex and Katya against each other; sibling challenges stay friendly and optional (the team bonus in GAME_DESIGN.md is the model).
- Support English and Russian family references where useful (language policy: EDUCATION.md → Language policy).
- Keep all real personal details private and local to their profiles.